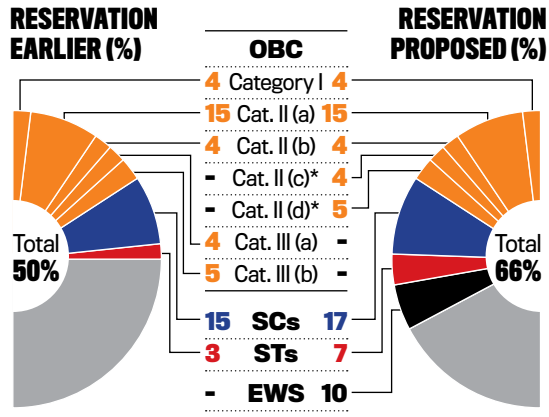
The Sangha, which has been pressing for an overall hike in reservation and for the inclusion of urban Vokkaligas under the EWS quota, says the community leaders have called for a detailed consultation on the matter.

C.S. Dwarakanath, a former Karnataka Backward Classes Commission chairman and a Congress spokesman, however, says the two new categories are just an eyewash and designed to fail in their current form. "The EWS cannot be applicable to communities already in the list of backward classes or SC/STs. If they want to give reservation under EWS, they have to remove them from the backward classes list," he reasons. Agrees Ashok Haranahalli, a former advocate general and president of the Akhila Karnataka Brahmana Mahasabha. "The question of now giving a portion remaining from the EWS category is nonsensical," he says.

Currently, both the Panchamashali and Vokkaliga leaders are awaiting the fine print. And the government says the exact quantum of quota hikes will be clear when the backward classes commission submits its final report in two-three months. ■

NEW SLICES ON THE QUOTA PIE



*Plus remainder from EWS quota



SMELTING? Rectification aside, Pinarayi can't drop the ball

man P. Jayarajan raised charges of financial irregularities and land-grabbing against his near-namesake and state Left Democratic Front convenor E.P. Jayarajan (EP). The charges include allegations that the CPI(M) central committee member and his family members have a majority stake in a Rs 30 crore Ayurveda resort, 'Vaidekam', in Morazha village in Kannur district. Incidentally, Morazha is the native village of Govindan Master and he has asked P. Jayarajan to submit a written complaint if he is bent on pursuing the charges against EP.

There are three Jayarajans who are considered party strongmen from Kannur. EP is the most flamboyant and gaffe-prone, P. Jayarajan is the most popular among the cadre (even after he has been sidelined), and then there is M.V. Jayarajan, the current CPI(M) Kannur district secretary. The three leaders have for long helped the Marxist party keep a vice-like hold on the violence-prone district, of course with the blessings of the other big Kannur natives, Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan and his late No. 2 Kodiyeri.

ALLEGATIONS OF CORRUPTION AGAINST A SENIOR CPI(M) LEADER, AND SO SOON AFTER A NEW DISPENSATION TOOK OVER, HAVE STUMPED THE PARTY CADRE

"P. Jayarajan's allegations against EP are not new really. It was raised earlier too when Kodiyeri was party secretary. But no probe was ordered considering his seniority," says a senior party leader who obviously did not want to be named. "EP wanted to become state secretary after Kodiyeri's death but was passed over in favour of Govindan Master who has also become a politburo member now. EP has been sulking since then, and has gone on leave pleading ill health. His 'resistance' to the regime change is considered a challenge to Govindan Master. P. Jayarajan's allegations, and that too at a public forum like the state committee, were scripted to hit back at EP."

The discussions in the state committee were soon leaked to the local media, which started off the